GAILIUS PRANINSKAS

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Last Updated: November 2026

Placement Officer: Matthias Doepke, M.Doepke@lse.ac.uk
Placement Team: Emma Taverner, Will McGeough, Paige Edwards, econ.facultysupport@lse.ac.uk

EDUCATION

PhD **London School of Economics and Political Science, Economics** *2022 – 2027 (expected)*
Fields: Political Economy, Economic History, Public Economics
MRes in Economics, Distinction (2024)

MASc **Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Data, Economics, Development Policy** *2020*

BSc **University of Amsterdam, Economics and Business** *2019*

REFERENCES

Tim Besley T.Besley@lse.ac.uk
School Professor of Economics and Political Science, London School of Economics

Jeremiah Dittmar J.E.Dittmar@lse.ac.uk
Associate Professor of Economics, London School of Economics

Noam Yuchtman n.yuchtman@lse.ac.uk
Hayek Professor of Political Economy, London School of Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

How Enfranchisement Led to Representation (with Ellen Munroe) Draft, November 2026

How did enfranchisement make Parliament more representative of the population? Was it because poorer politicians were elected and advocated different policies, or because all politicians responded to new voters? We study Britain's democratisation, combining 17 million wealth-at-death records with biographies of Members of Parliament (MPs) to place politicians, their fathers and voters in the same wealth distribution from 1858 to 1990. The wealth gap between MPs' fathers and the population fell from 2,900 times in the 1860s to 7 in the 1980s. We estimate the effect of the enfranchisement Acts of 1867, 1884, 1918 and 1928 across cohorts of politicians and across constituencies. Poorer constituencies voted for the party that fielded poorer candidates, but the early Acts barely changed MPs' backgrounds or Parliament's attention to the poor. Enfranchisement brought MPs from poor backgrounds into Parliament only after 1900, once Labour and trade unions financed their candidacies. Analysing 5.9 million parliamentary speeches, we find that these MPs advocated for policies benefiting the poor, which Parliament then began to pass. MPs from rich backgrounds did not argue more for the poor when their own voters became poorer. Enfranchisement changed policy by changing who was elected.

WORKING PAPERS

Class, Party and Status in Political Dynasties (with Ellen Munroe) Working paper, November 2026
Why do the children of politicians so often become politicians themselves? They may inherit economic capital (class), political capital (party) or social capital (status). We study dynasties in Britain between 1850 and 1979 and ask how each affects access to Parliament and the ability, effort and behaviour of MPs in office, comparing the children of MPs and peers with the children of equally wealthy fathers. All three increased access, and the advantages stacked on top of each other. Fathers in the top 1 percent of wealth were 42 times as likely as all men to have a child who became an MP. At equal wealth, fathers who were MPs were five times as likely, peers five times, and fathers who were both eleven times. The children of rich non-politicians entered once the father died, the children of MPs while he was alive, and the children of peers regardless of when he died. The advantage of the children of MPs came mostly from the father's standing with party selectors. An MP who narrowly kept his seat when his children were of age was more than twice as likely to see one enter at the next elections, and the children of MPs were placed in safer seats but won no more votes. No type of dynast was more able or exerted more effort. In office, party dynasts took up their father's issues, and every type of dynast spoke more on high politics.

Privatising Common Property: Evidence from the Welsh Enclosures (with Ellen Munroe). Draft on request
Economists stress that well-defined private property rights matter for efficiency and development, yet little is known about what happens when common land is privatised. We study the Welsh Parliamentary Enclosures: 227 Acts of Parliament, 1760–1936, that put communally owned or managed land under a single owner. We digitise every Welsh enclosure and link them to parish censuses, grain prices and land-ownership records. Contrary to common historical accounts, enclosure did not reduce population or change farming occupations, and it was not associated with grain prices. Enclosed parishes ended up with significantly lower land values and less concentrated land ownership than unenclosed parishes. We argue that enclosure created many fragmented holdings, which led to hold-up and other contracting problems.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Why Become a Politician? Pecuniary Incentives and Selection (with Ellen Munroe)
Do people enter politics because office is lucrative or because they want to change policy? We observe the wealth at death of winning and losing candidates since 1832, across the introduction of MPs' salaries in 1911 and the parties' assumption of campaign costs after 1949. Comparing winners and losers of close elections, we find that office paid only for Conservatives after 1945; for everyone else, politics was not lucrative. A Roy model of entry then tells us who should have entered under each motive; who did enter is consistent with candidates seeking to change policy.

How Do Political Movements Form?
What turned an industrial movement of trade unions into a political one? I ask whether it was the prospect of representation, using new data on every union, trades council and party branch in Britain from 1869 to 1920. After the Taff Vale judgment of 1901 made union funds liable for strike damages, the share of union members in unions affiliated to Labour rose from 18 to 44 percent within two years.

Wealth Is Health? Life Expectancy and Public Goods (with Ellen Munroe)
We ask whether the rise in life expectancy since the mid-nineteenth century came from economic growth or from public health, and who gained from each. We measure age at death by the wealth of the family a person was born into, for everyone from 1858. Most of the gain was a shift of the whole curve: people at every level of wealth lived longer, so the gains came from what was provided to everyone. We ask which public goods did this and who demanded them, and find that the towns that built public water and sewerage were the richest, not those where most poor people had the vote.

A Century of Women in Power? Household Composition and Women's Representation
Why did women's representation in parliaments rise only decades after women could vote? I argue that representation followed a change in household composition. As long as most women lived in their fathers' or husbands' households, they voted as their households did. Women who lived on their own voted independently. In eight Western European countries, young unmarried women moved to the left from the 1980s, and parties of the left then fielded more women candidates. Parties of the left reached 20 percent women ten to twenty years before parties of the right, after young women's votes had changed. In most countries, party and national quotas were adopted after this change in women's votes. I study the mechanisms in the UK, using Gallup polls from 1955 to 1991. Young women living on their own moved to the left first, in the 1970s, and all young unmarried women followed by the mid-1980s. Married women did not change who they voted for. Women voters then began to prefer women candidates, and parties responded by fielding more women.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

RCTs & Human Uplift Studies: Methodological Challenges and Practical Solutions for Frontier AI Evaluation (with Patricia Paskov, Kevin Wei, Shen Hong, Dan Bateyko, Xavier Roberts-Gaal, Carson Ezell, Valerie Chen, Umang Bhatt and Ella Guest). *Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society*, 9(3), 2036–2052, 2026.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

LSE Class Teacher Award	*2026*
LSE Summer School Class Teacher Award	*2024*
ESRC DTP PhD Fellowship	*2022 – 2026*
Marius Jakulis Jason Knowledge Grant, Kitas 100 and Talentai Lietuvai Study Grants	*2020*

RESEARCH GRANTS

Michio Morishima Fund	*2024*
STICERD Small Grant	*2024*
Hayek Programme Grant	*2023*

PRESENTATIONS

2026 2nd Warwick-LSE Political Economy PhD Conference; HYRCE, Liège; KIZ Political Economy Workshop; Linnaeus Inequality Summit; LSE Seminar for Political Economy and Economic History (SPEECH)

2025 Danish Historical Political Economy Workshop; Royal Economic Society Annual Conference; 14th Annual Lithuanian Conference on Economic Research; Warwick-LSE Political Economy PhD Conference; Oxford Political Economy Work in Progress; LSE Political Science Political Economy Work in Progress; SPEECH

2024 LSE Workshop on Institutions and Political Economy; SPEECH

ACADEMIC SERVICE

SPEECH Seminar (Political Economy and Economic History), **Co-Founder**	*2023 – Present*
Warwick-LSE PhD Political Economy Conference, **Co-Founder**	*2024 – Present*
PhD Applicant Mentoring Programme, LSE, Coordinator	*2023 – 2025*
PhD Applicant Mentoring Programme, LSE, Mentor	*2022 – Present*
PhD Student Representative, LSE	*2022 – 2024*
Referee: Economica	*2024 – Present*

TEACHING

London School of Economics	Teaching evaluation summary
EC307 – Development Economics	*2025 – Present*
EC2B5 – Macroeconomics II	*2026*
EC260 – The Political Economy of Public Policy	*2024 – 2026*
EC317 – Labour Economics	*2024 – 2026*
EC101 – Introductory Microeconomics	*2024*
EC2C1 – Econometrics II	*2024*
FM250 – Finance	*2024 – 2025*
EC400 – Probability and Statistics	*2023 – 2026*
EC1A3 – Microeconomics I	*2023*
University of Amsterdam	
Economics of Markets and Organizations	*2019 – 2020*
Principles of Economics II	*2018 – 2020*
Principles of Economics I	*2017 – 2019*
Quantitative Data Analysis	*2018*

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Gilat Levy and Ronny Razin, LSE	*2023 – 2024*
Research Assistant to Michael Best, Columbia University	*2021*
Consultant, OECD	*2022*
Field Coordinator and Consultant, World Bank Bureaucracy Lab	*2020 – 2022*

Team contribution: *Governance of the Service Delivery Chain for Youth Mental Health in Lithuania*, World Bank Group, June 2022.

DATA

Wealth and Political Power in England and Wales, 1832–2005 (with Ellen Munroe).
The wealth at death of every Member of Parliament and other members of the political elite (Lords, High Court Judges), and their fathers, matched by hand to probate calendars; every parliamentary candidacy since 1832; the wealth and franchise of every constituency's population at every election, 1832–1990; and 7.3 million Hansard speeches, 1803–2005, merged to speaker identity and classified by the side each MP took in each debate.

Geolocated Probates for England and Wales, 1858–1990 (with Ellen Munroe).
The wealth-at-death of every person who died in England and Wales. 17 million wealth values from the probate calendars, linked to the 71 million civil death registrations, with address and registration district at death.

OTHER INFORMATION

Software: Python, R, Stata, LaTeX
Languages: English, Lithuanian
Nationality: Lithuanian